Flight Dynamics of the Bell Boeing V-22 Osprey in JSBSim

A blade-element tiltrotor model, built and checked as the XV-15 from NASA's data and carried to the V-22 with its published rotor, wing and performance data

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Abstract

A flight-dynamics model of the Bell Boeing V-22 Osprey for the FlightGear simulator has been written in JSBSim, replacing the parametric YASim model the aircraft used before. The V-22's engineering data are not public; those of its technology demonstrator, the Bell XV-15, are: Bell's real-time simulation data from its wind tunnel tests, NASA's hover test of its full-scale rotor and its flight tests. The model is therefore built and checked as an XV-15 first and carried to the V-22 with the V-22's published rotor geometry, wing, weights, engine ratings and performance charts. Each of the two three-bladed gimballed proprotors is simulated blade by blade, eight segments per blade in cambered-section tables at their own angle of attack and Mach number, under a Peters–He finite-state wake with ground effect; the gimbal's two degrees of freedom carry the pitch–flap coupling ($\delta_3 = -15°$). The nacelles tilt from 97.5° to airplane mode inside the conversion corridor; Bell's wing, fuselage and empennage tables, scaled, sit in the rotors' ring-vortex wakes; an interconnected drive with its torque limit, two engines, the collective governor and a stability augmentation complete it. The whole model, 774 aerodynamic functions and 356 control-system components, is generated by a script from transcribed data and runs in plain JSBSim at 480 Hz. As an XV-15 its isolated rotor needs −4.6 to +0.9 % of the measured hover power from $C_T/\sigma = 0.08$ to 0.18 (the section's stall fitted) and reaches $C_T/\sigma = 0.188$ against the test's 0.181; its wing's download follows the flight tests' within 1.0 point of thrust (fitted). In level flight, with the test altitudes unpublished, the model brackets the measured power through the conversion between sea level and 10 000 ft, but in airplane mode with the gear up it needs −35 to −24 % of it at 10 000 ft: Bell's airframe coefficients miss drag the aircraft had. As a V-22, with 11.5 ft^2 of parasite drag fitted to Boeing's airframe polar and the drive's torque limit fitted to the sea-level hover ceiling, its maximum level speed at 42 000 lb is 289 and 316 KTAS at sea level and 17 000 ft against 274 and 321, its hover ceiling at 8400 and 16 000 ft −2 and +5 % from Boeing's chart, and its pitch attitude through the conversion within 3.0° (rms) of the flight test's. Deficiencies are quantified: the XV-15's power in helicopter mode, +21 % at 45 kt and −29 % at 94 kt; its collective gradient in hover, 34 % steeper than measured; the V-22 wing's download, 11.7 % of thrust against 9.2; and the wing's share of the lift at 30° of nacelle.

1 Introduction

The V-22 distributed for FlightGear flies on YASim, whose helicopter model builds a rotor from a short list of geometric parameters and tuning factors and has no notion of a tiltrotor: the stock aircraft tilts its rotors' thrust and lets the wing take over. What makes the tiltrotor hard is precisely what such a model leaves out: two large, highly twisted proprotors that have to hover like a helicopter's rotor and cruise like propellers, the gimbal that lets each disc tilt as a whole, the wing that sits in their downwash in the hover (its download) and in their slipstream in cruise, and the conversion between the two, flown inside a corridor of nacelle angle against airspeed.

The V-22's own engineering data are not public. Its technology demonstrator's are: Bell documented the XV-15's real-time simulation in 1973 down to every wind tunnel table [1], NASA tested its full-scale rotor in hover [3], and NASA and the Army flew it and compared the simulation with the flights [4, 5]. For the V-22 itself Boeing and Bell published the rotor's geometry, the wing's planform, the airframe's lift and drag, the download, hover ceilings, the flight envelope [6] and the flight test results through the conversion [7]; NASA the rotor's characteristics [8, 9]. So the model is built as an XV-15 first, checked against the XV-15's tests, and then carried to the V-22 by its published data, each XV-15 quantity that has no V-22 counterpart scaled by geometry and marked as such.

This report describes the JSBSim [19] model built on that material, after UH-60A and Bo 105 models built the same way, and how well it reproduces the tests. All of the flight model, the blades' integration, the gimbals, the wakes, the engines and drive, the governor and the augmentation, is JSBSim XML; the FlightGear side only animates and instruments it. All result tables, figures and the numbers quoted from them are written by the evaluation scripts.

2 Reference data

Table 1 lists the sources; most are scans, and every curve used was digitised from them. A few points of data reduction matter for the comparisons. *(i)* Bell's simulation data [1] are complete but for one value: the wing–pylon pitching moment at zero lift for the third flap setting is illegible in the scan (page B-12) and taken as −0.20. *(ii)* The XV-15 rotor's hover test [3] gives its power as the report's curve fit through the wind-corrected data, C_P/σ against C_T/σ ($\sigma = 0.0891$), and its collective from the actuator's position, whose reference to a blade station is not given; it is compared here as a gradient. *(iii)* The XV-15's level-flight power [4] is published with neither the gross weight nor the altitudes; the flight envelope puts most of the programme between 2000 and 10 000 ft density altitude [5], so the model is flown at 13 000 lb at sea level and at 10 000 ft, which bracket it. Nor is the landing gear's position given; the gear is up throughout (Section 5.2). *(iv)* Dunford's conversion charts [7] give no weight, altitude or flap setting. Their airplane-mode pitch attitude, 13.6° at 108 kt falling to 0.2° at 170 kt, asks for a lift coefficient of 0.82 at zero angle of attack with Boeing's lift slope [6]: about 31 500 lb at sea level, below the MV-22B's empty weight. The comparisons run at 34 000 lb, sea level. *(v)* Boeing's hover ceiling and flight envelope [6] are for the 1986 design with 6150 shp engines and a standard day.

Table 1: Sources and what they contribute.

Source	Content used
NASA CR-114614 [1]	Bell's Model 301 (XV-15) simulation data: wing–pylon, fuselage and empennage tables, downwash, control mixing and rigging, governor, mass and inertia
NASA TM X-62407 [2]	XV-15 familiarisation: controls, flaperons, conversion range
NASA TM-86833 [3]	full-scale XV-15 rotor in hover: power against thrust, collective, blade twist, chord and sections
NASA TM-84222 [4]	XV-15 level-flight rotor shaft power from flight test by nacelle angle and flap (fig. 20)
12th ERF, paper 14 [6]	V-22 design data, rotor geometry and sections, wing, download against flap (XV-15 flight and V-22 0.658-scale test), airframe polar, hover ceiling, flight envelope
16th ERF, II.7.3 [7]	V-22 control system, conversion corridor, rotor speeds, airframe lift share and pitch attitude through the conversion, power required
NASA/TM-2016-219070 [8]	JVX (0.656-scale V-22) rotor characteristics, precone
Johnson, AHS 2001 [9]	1/4-scale V-22 rotor (TRAM): sections, δ_3, chord and twist
V-22 fact sheet [10]; GlobalSecurity [11]	weights, fuel capacity, crew; the MV-22's tanks and their transfer sequence
NACA R-824 [12]	64-series sections' lift, stall and drag (the sections' parameters)
NASA TN D-234, NACA TR 1319 [13, 14]	ground effect in forward flight; ring-vortex wake
Peters and He [15], via [16]	finite-state dynamic wake

3 The model

3.1 Implementation

A Python script writes the model from the transcribed tables (Table 2), the XV-15 or the V-22 from the same code with each aircraft's data. JSBSim evaluates aerodynamic functions on demand, so the function graph must be free of cycles; every quantity that depends on its own past, the gimbals' tilt and rate, the rotor azimuth and speed, the wake states, the nacelle angle, the engines' states, the governor's and the augmentation's integrators, therefore lives in flight-control-system channels, which JSBSim runs once per frame in a fixed order and which can write properties back. These integrate explicitly at 480 Hz, the rate FlightGear runs the model at: at 104 % rotor speed 5.2° of azimuth per step. The airframe's wake and ground-effect tables run every fourth frame, the engines and the outputs to FlightGear every eighth. The same XML runs in FlightGear and in the offline harness used here; FlightGear sets only the pilot's controls and reads the outputs.

3.2 Proprotors

Each rotor's three blades are rigid and sit with their precone (2.5° [8, 3]) on a gimbal, so the disc tilts as a whole, as on both aircraft. The gimbal's two degrees of freedom, in the non-rotating frame, are integrated from the blades' aerodynamic flapping moments about the hub, the gyroscopic coupling of the shaft's rotation (taken exactly, as a rotation of the tilt each step), the airframe's angular rates and a hub spring; each blade's pitch takes $\tan\delta_3$ of its own flapping, $\delta_3 = -15°$ [1, 9]. The blades' inertia about the gimbal is the XV-15's Lock number's (3.8), scaled. Eight segments of equal annulus area from $0.15\,R$ (V-22; $0.1\,R$ XV-15) see the air velocity at their midpoint from the full kinematics: the aircraft's motion, the nacelle's tilting rate, the rotor's rotation, the gimbal's tilt and rate and the induced velocity. The left rotor is the right one's mirror image and is computed as the right rotor of the mirror-image aircraft.

Neither rotor's section tables are public: the XV-15's metal blades use NACA 64-series sections [3], the V-22's Boeing's XN sections of 28 % thickness at $0.2\,R$ to 9 % at the tip [6, 9]. Each segment's section is built as C-81's equations build the NACA 0012, with the parameters of a cambered section of its thickness and design lift [12]: a lift slope and zero-lift angle from the camber, a maximum lift falling with thickness and Mach number, a trailing-edge stall that rounds over into the maximum and falls gently past it to a flat plate's normal force, Korn's drag divergence. The stall's shape, its maximum lift ($C_{l\max} = 1.55$ at zero camber) and the separated drag are *fitted* to the XV-15 rotor's hover power at high thrust (Section 5.1). The V-22's twist, 47.5° from the root to the tip, and its chord, 34.3 in extrapolated to the centre to 22 in at the tip, are Boeing's [6, 9]; the tip loss factor is 0.97.

Table 2: The generated V-22 model: JSBSim system files, their content and the number of named aerodynamic functions or control-system components.

File	Content	n
`-aero.xml`	the aerodynamic functions: blade segments of both rotors, gimbal moments, wing strips in the wakes, fuselage, empennage; the six axes	774
`-rotors.xml`	gimbals, rotor azimuth, Peters–He wake states of each rotor	57
`-airframe.xml`	ring-vortex wake at the wing, stabiliser and fins; ground effect	157
`-drive.xml`	engines, torque limit, interconnected drive and rotor speed, rotor brake, fuel	37
`-controls.xml`	pilot controls, mixing, nacelles and conversion protection, flaperons, governor, augmentation, servos	63
`-outputs.xml`	properties for the 3-D model and the instruments	42

3.3 Inflow and wake

Each rotor has its own Peters–He finite-state wake [15, 16], three axisymmetric states and the first harmonic pair, in the shaft's frame as the nacelle tilts. Ground effect scales the induced velocity by $(1+0.3(R/Z)^2)^{-1/2}$ in the hover, with Z the hub's height, carried into forward flight with Heyson's interference ratios [13]. Each rotor's downwash at the wing, the horizontal stabiliser and the two fins comes from a skewed cylinder of ring vortices leaving the disc [14], contracting below it in the hover: averaged over four spanwise strips of each wing half, the stabiliser and each fin, and tabulated against the wake's skew, its direction in the disc's plane and the nacelle

angle, which moves the hub and turns the disc.

3.4 Airframe

The wing–pylon, fuselage, horizontal stabiliser and fin data are Bell's tables for the XV-15 [1]: the wing's lift and drag against angle of attack, flap setting and mast angle, its downwash at the tail, the fuselage's forces and moments in equation form, the stabiliser's and fins' coefficients with their blockage. For the V-22 the wing's are applied to its own area, span and chord (382 ft^2, 45.8 ft [6]), the empennage's to its surfaces, and the fuselage's scaled by the length ratio squared and cubed. Each wing half is four strips in the rotors' wakes, with the local flow's angle of attack. In the hover the wakes push the wing down; the download is Bell's flap-dependent coefficient in the wake's velocity times a factor *fitted* to the XV-15's download in flight for each flap setting (Section 5.3). Bell's coefficients miss part of the V-22's parasite drag: 11.5 ft^2 is added, *fitted* to Boeing's airframe polar, flaps and gear up (Section 5.4). The landing gear adds Bell's drag areas, scaled, when extended.

3.5 Flight controls

The cockpit controls' mixing is Bell's for the XV-15 [1], in its control travel: the thrust control lever sets both rotors' collective (its slope falling to zero in airplane mode), the lateral stick their differential collective, the longitudinal stick their longitudinal cyclic, the pedals their differential cyclic, each phased with the mast angle, while the elevator, flaperons and rudders follow the stick and pedals in all modes. The nacelles move at up to 8°/s from 97.5° (7.5° aft of vertical) to 0, their command held within the conversion corridor against equivalent airspeed [7]. The flaperons' schedule is not public; they are at 67° in the hover for the least download [6], at 40° through the conversion and in airplane mode below 120 kt (the corridor's lower boundary is the wing's stall at 40° of flap [7]) and retract by 200 kt (an estimate). A collective governor holds the rotor speed's reference, 104 % in helicopter and conversion modes and 84 % in airplane mode [7], proportional and integral within Bell's collective limits.

The V-22 flies by wire and holds attitude in all modes [7]; its control laws are not public. The FlightGear aircraft has a stability augmentation of a common rotorcraft structure: rate damping in three axes for a 0.5 s rate time constant in the hover; attitude command and heading hold below 50 kt with the nacelles above 60° and rate command with attitude hold above, switched without a transient because both share one reference [17]; a feed-forward of the level-flight trim's stick against nacelle angle and airspeed, from the model's own trims, so that the stick's centre is trimmed flight through the conversion; and integrators that take up the rest. The comparisons of Section 5 fly the bare airframe, the augmentation off.

3.6 Engines, drive and mass

The engines are not modelled in detail: the lever sets each one's power demand from flight idle to its rating (6150 shp each [6]), falling with altitude as $\delta/\sqrt{\theta}$; the engine follows with a 0.6 s lag, and a topping governor takes power off above 2 % of overspeed. The interconnected drive gears both rotors to one speed, with the rotors', the power turbines' and the interconnect shaft's inertia; the drive's torque limit, shared between the running engines, is *fitted* to Boeing's sea-level hover ceiling (9130 hp at 100 % rotor speed; Section 5.5). A start brings each engine from rest to flight idle in 30 s. The MV-22B's five tanks (1448 US gal [10, 11]) are drained in the transfer sequence's order. Each nacelle, 7000 lb with its engine, gearbox and rotor (15 % of the gross weight, as the XV-15's pylons [1]), tilts with its centre of gravity and inertia. The reference loading is 47 500 lb, the 1986 design's maximum vertical take-off weight [6], at a centre of gravity under the hubs in helicopter mode: the empty weight (33 140 lb [10]), three crew, the tanks full but for the right aft sponson and the rest as cargo. The inertias are the XV-15's scaled by mass and dimensions. Table 3 lists the principal data.

Table 3: Principal data of the two builds.

Item	V-22	XV-15
Rotor radius, ft	19.04	12.50
Blades per rotor	3	3
Precone, deg	2.50	2.50
δ_3, deg	-15	-15
Chord root (extrapolated) / tip, in	34.3 / 22.0	14.0 / 14.0
Rotor speed 100 %, rpm	397	589
Rotor speed, helicopter/airplane, %	104 / 84	100 / 88
Wing area, ft^2; span, ft	382; 45.83	181; 32.17
Engines, shp each	6150	1550
Drive torque limit at 100 %, hp	9130 (fitted)	2500
Nacelle angle range, deg; rate, deg/s	0–97.5; 8	0–95.0; 8
Reference gross weight, lb	47500	13000
Empty weight, lb	33140	–
Fuel, US gal (tanks)	1448 (5)	–

4 Method

The evaluation drives JSBSim from Python with the same files as FlightGear, at 480 Hz, the augmentation off and the gear up (in the hover its drag is nil). A trim solves for the collective, the cyclic or elevator, the pedals, the angle of attack and the roll that zero the six body accelerations, averaged over whole rotor revolutions (Hann-weighted), with the airframe held and the rotor at the governed speed, by Newton's method with a backtracking line search. The programme:

- *the XV-15 rotor in hover*: the XV-15 build held far from the ground at the test's tip Mach number (589 rpm, 1000 ft), swept in collective; the right rotor's thrust and power;
- *XV-15 level-flight power*: trims at 13 000 lb at sea level and 10 000 ft by calibrated airspeed for each of the test's nacelle and flap settings, the flaperons at 0.625 of the flap [2];
- *download*: hover trims out of ground effect at sea level, the XV-15 at its flight tests' flap settings, the V-22 at 67°;
- *V-22 airframe polar*: the airframe's own forces in airplane mode at 198 KTAS (Mach 0.3) and 3000 ft, flaps and gear up, the rotors at zero thrust;
- *V-22 performance*: the maximum level speed in airplane mode at 84 % rotor speed, where the power required meets the engines' power or the drive's limit; the hover ceiling out of ground effect at 100 % rotor speed (the 1986 chart's); trims through the conversion at 34 000 lb by nacelle angle;
- *handling* with the augmentation on: single keyboard steps

Table 4: The isolated XV-15 rotor in hover: power and figure of merit at the model's thrust.

θ_{75}	C_T/σ	C_P/σ, model / test		Δ %	FM, model / test	
8.0	0.085	0.00704	0.00698	+0.9	0.742	0.748
9.0	0.097	0.00828	0.00831	−0.3	0.769	0.767
10.0	0.109	0.00967	0.00971	−0.4	0.786	0.783
11.0	0.121	0.01122	0.01138	−1.4	0.796	0.784
12.0	0.134	0.01291	0.01324	−2.5	0.799	0.779
13.0	0.146	0.01476	0.01527	−3.3	0.795	0.769
14.0	0.157	0.01679	0.01761	−4.6	0.783	0.746
15.0	0.167	0.01900	0.01982	−4.2	0.761	0.729
16.0	0.176	0.02147	0.02234	−3.9	0.726	0.698

Table 5: XV-15 level-flight power, model/test −1 at the test's points.

Nacelle, flaps	KCAS	sea level, %	10 000 ft, %
90°, flaps 20°	0–94	−29 to +21	+8 to +42
60°, flaps 20°	97–134	−19 to −7	+2 to +9
30°, flaps 20°	126–167	−13 to −8	+1 to +8
0°, flaps 20°	134–180	−23 to −14	−14 to −7
0°, flaps up	156–232	−41 to −29	−35 to −24
0°, flaps up, gear down	156–232	−20 to −6	−13 to +3

in the hover, a hands-off conversion, an engine start.

5 Results

5.1 The XV-15 rotor in hover

From $C_T/\sigma = 0.08$ to 0.18 the rotor needs −4.6 to +0.9 % of the test's power at the same thrust (Fig. 1, Table 4), the figure of merit peaking at 0.80 at $C_T/\sigma = 0.13$ against the test's 0.79 at 0.12, and the rotor reaches $C_T/\sigma = 0.188$ at 19° of collective, where the test, which stopped at 0.181, did not go. The sections' stall was fitted here, so this checks the shape of the curve rather than predicts it. Below $C_T/\sigma = 0.075$ the model needs 3–21 % more power than the test, more the lower the thrust: the profile power of the inboard sections, whose thick XN-like stand-ins have more drag at low lift than the 64-series. The thrust's gradient against collective is 0.0114 per degree against the test's 0.0085 (34 % steeper): the test's collective is the actuator's, which includes the blades' elastic twist under load, which the rigid blades do not have. Past the maximum thrust the blades stall progressively and the gimbal whirls by a few degrees; the model's power there (the points that turn back in Fig. 1a) has no test to compare with.

5.2 XV-15 level-flight power

Through the conversion, nacelles at 60° and 30° with 20° of flap, the test lies between the model at sea level and at 10 000 ft (Fig. 2, Table 5): −19 to −7 % and −13 to −8 % at sea level, +2 to +9 % and +1 to +8 % at 10 000 ft, as the test's altitudes would have it. In airplane mode the model needs less power than the test at either altitude: −23 to −14 % with 20° of flap at sea level and, flaps up, −41 to −29 % at sea level and −35 to −24 % at 10 000 ft. With the gear extended, its 4 ft^2 of drag [1] brings the flaps-up power to −13 to +3 % at 10 000 ft; the test's gear position is not given, but in airplane mode it would have been up. Bell's airframe coefficients, from wind tunnel tests of the clean model, miss part of the flying aircraft's drag; the V-22's needed 11.5 ft^2 more to meet Boeing's polar for the same reason (Section 5.4). The XV-15 build keeps Bell's data as they are.

Table 6: Download in the hover, % of the rotors' thrust.

Aircraft	flap, deg	model, %	test, %	Δ
XV-15	0	16.3	16.4	−0.1
XV-15	40	13.0	13.0	−0.0
XV-15	60	11.4	10.4	+1.0
XV-15	75	10.2	10.5	−0.3
V-22	67	11.7	9.2	+2.5

Table 7: V-22 airframe drag coefficient at Boeing's lift coefficients, on 382 ft^2; Δ in drag counts.

C_L	C_D model	C_D test	Δ, counts
0.18	0.0652	0.0680	−28
0.30	0.0685	0.0670	+15
0.55	0.0780	0.0770	+10
1.00	–	0.1150	–

In helicopter mode the model's power falls too fast with speed: +21 % at 45 kt, −29 % at 94 kt at sea level, +7 % in the hover. Bell's own simulation used an empirical profile power for the rotor in this regime; the blade elements here give a translational lift that lowers the induced power faster than the test, and the wing in the slipstream at a high angle of attack, with 20° of flap, sees the wake model's velocities, whose sweep off the wing through the transition is not checked by any test.

5.3 Download

The download factor of each of Bell's flap settings was fitted to the XV-15's flight-measured download, which the model then follows within 1.0 point of thrust (Fig. 3a, Table 6). Carried to the V-22 with its own wing and rotors, at the hover's 67° of flaperon, it gives 11.7 % against the 0.658-scale test's 9.2 %: the V-22's flaperons, which fold down over a larger part of the chord than the XV-15's flaps, take more of the wing out of the wake than the XV-15's tables know.

5.4 V-22 airframe polar

Bell's wing and empennage tables applied to the V-22's surfaces give it a lift coefficient of 0.21 at zero angle of attack and a slope of 0.099 per degree, against Boeing's 0.18 and about 0.093 (Fig. 3b, Table 7). Its drag, with the 11.5 ft^2 fitted here, is 0.0651 at $C_L = 0.2$ against 0.068; the model's polar is flatter than Boeing's estimate, whose drag rises faster beyond $C_L = 0.6$.

5.5 V-22 performance

The drive's torque limit was fitted to the hover ceiling at sea level, 47 700 lb, where Boeing's chart has its knee: the transmission limits there, the engines above. With it the ceiling is 42 290.0 lb at 8400 ft (−2 %) and 32 580.0 lb at 16 000 ft (+5 %), where the engines' lapse sets it (Fig. 4, Table 8). At 42 000 lb the maximum level speed is 289 KTAS at sea level

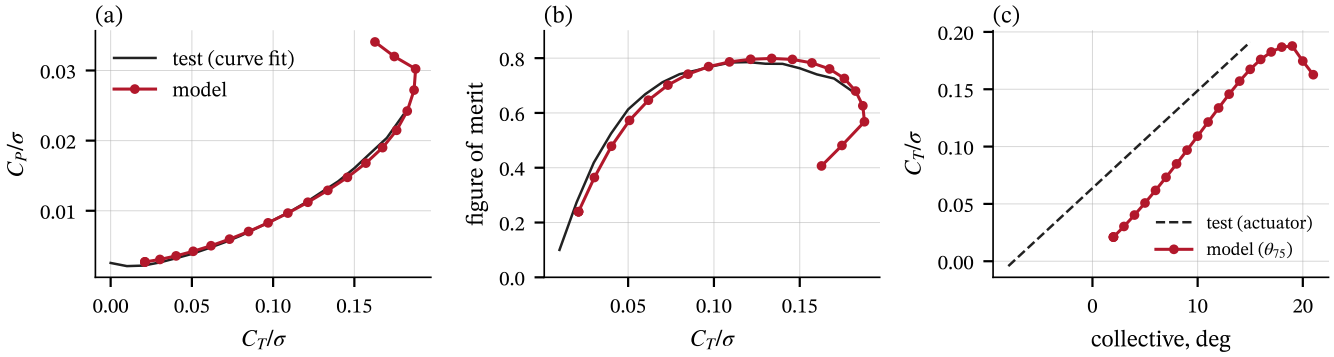


Figure 1: The isolated XV-15 rotor in hover at a tip Mach number of 0.69 against NASA's full-scale test (TM-86833 figs. 13, 14, 17): (a) power against thrust, (b) figure of merit, (c) thrust against collective (the test's from the actuator's position, the model's at 0.75 R).

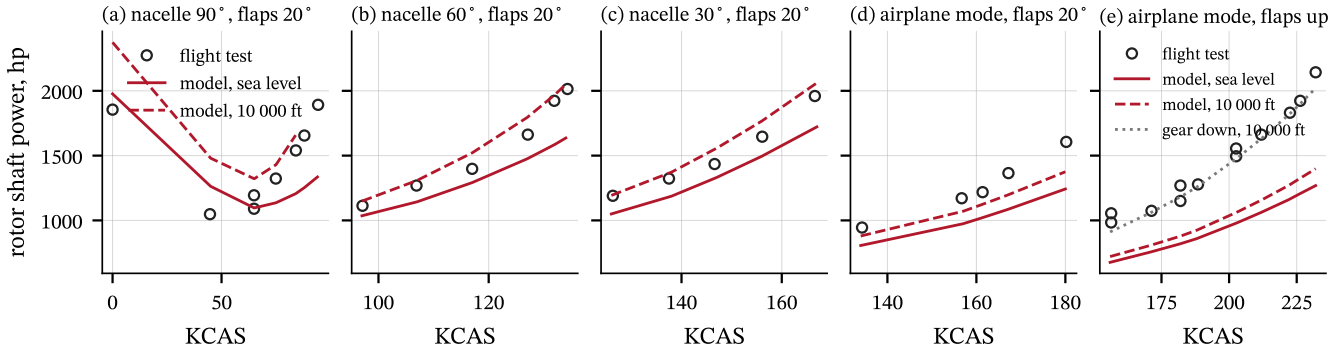


Figure 2: XV-15 rotor shaft power in level flight against the flight test (TM-84222 fig. 20) at 13 000 lb: the model at sea level and at 10 000 ft, which bracket the test's unpublished altitudes, gear up; in (e) also with the gear down.

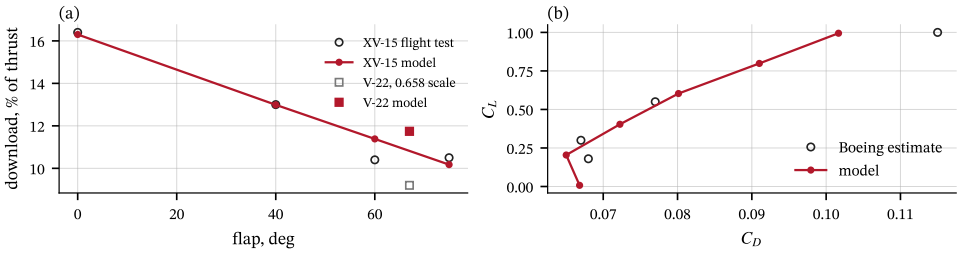


Figure 3: (a) The wing's download in the hover against flap angle: the XV-15 (13 300 lb, flight test [6] fig. 18) and the V-22 at 67° (0.658-scale rotor and wing test). (b) The V-22 airframe's lift and drag in airplane mode, flaps and gear up, against Boeing's full-scale estimate [6] fig. 28.

Table 8: V-22 performance, model and Boeing's charts.

Quantity	model	test [6]
maximum level speed, 42000 lb, 0 ft	289 KTAS	274 KTAS
maximum level speed, 47500 lb, 0 ft	286 KTAS	–
maximum level speed, 42000 lb, 17 000 ft	316 KTAS	321 KTAS
hover ceiling OGE at 0 ft	47690 lb	47 700 lb
hover ceiling OGE at 4 000 ft	45411 lb	–
hover ceiling OGE at 8 400 ft	42286 lb	43 300 lb
hover ceiling OGE at 12 000 ft	37623 lb	–
hover ceiling OGE at 16 000 ft	32579 lb	31 000 lb

against 274, limited by the drive's torque at 84 % rotor speed, and 316 KTAS at 17 000 ft against 321, limited by the engines.

5.6 The conversion

The pitch attitude follows the flight test through the conversion within 3.0° (rms; Fig. 5, Table 9), the model a few degrees nose-up of it at the higher speeds of each nacelle angle. The wing carries 8 % of the weight less than Dunford's chart (rms), most at 30° of nacelle, where the model's wing carries 62–72 % against 83–87 %: at that angle the rotors' slipstream over the wing, which the wake model gives, decides the wing's lift, and no test checks it. The charts' weight and flaps are not published (Section 2).

Table 9: Conversion, model minus test.

Nacelle, deg	KCAS	wing lift, % of W	pitch, deg
90	0–82	−11 to −1	−3.2 to +4.5
75	37–101	−11 to +1	−2.8 to +3.4
60	60–126	−7 to −0	+0.1 to +3.9
30	110–168	−25 to −10	+3.0 to +6.1
0	116–184	−10 to −4	+0.6 to +4.7

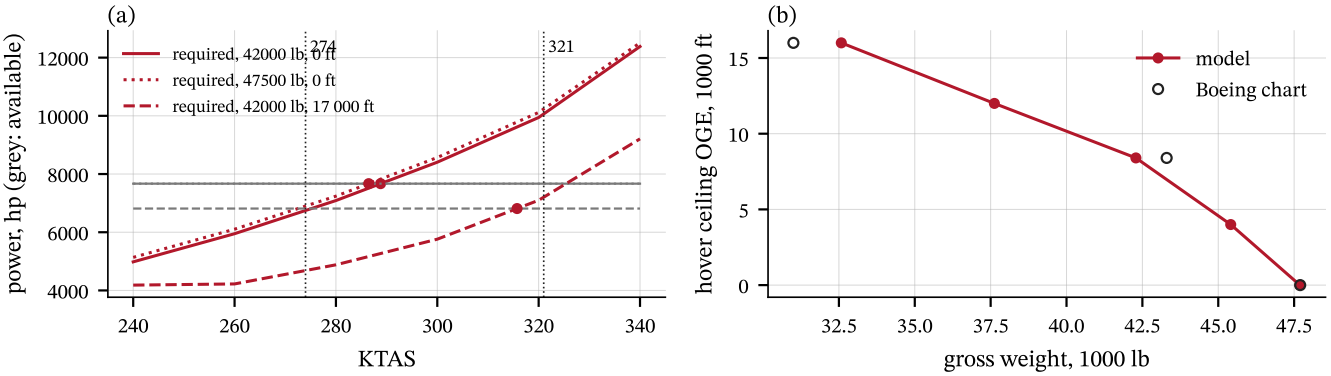


Figure 4: V-22 performance against Boeing's charts [6] (standard day, 6150 shp engines): (a) power required in airplane mode at 84 % rotor speed and power available (grey: the engines' rating or the drive's torque limit, whichever is less); the dotted verticals are the chart's maximum speeds at 42 000 lb. (b) Hover ceiling out of ground effect at 100 % rotor speed.

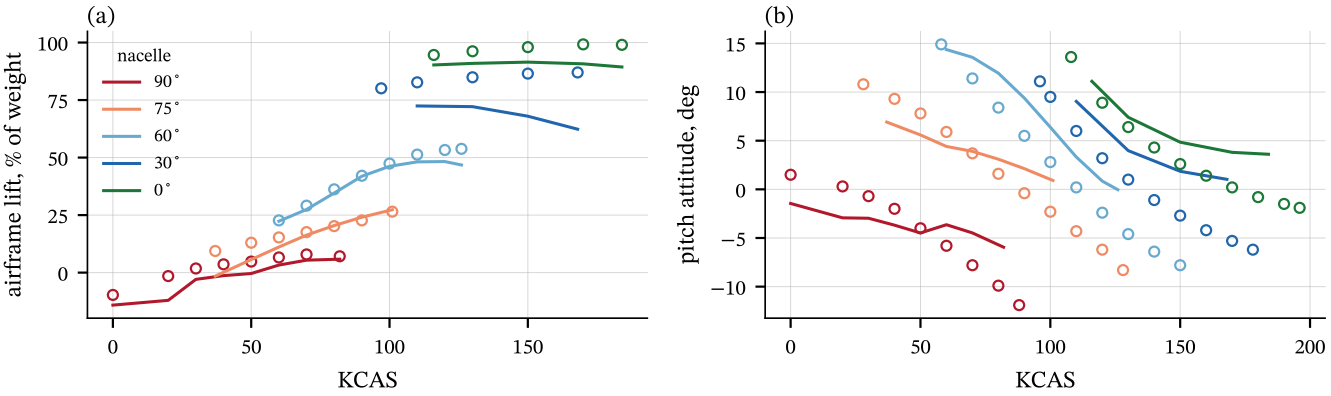


Figure 5: Trims through the conversion at 34 000 lb, sea level, against the V-22's flight test [7] figs. 7 and 9a: (a) the airframe's share of the lift, (b) pitch attitude, by nacelle angle (circles: test).

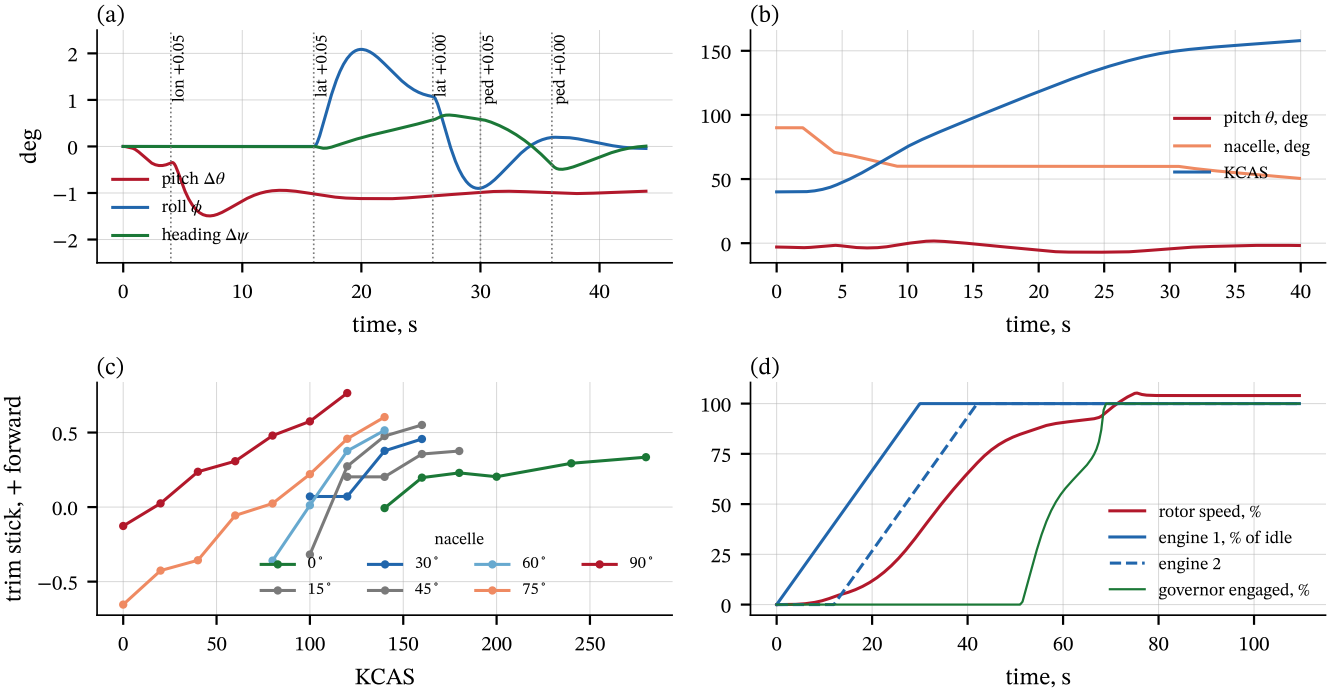


Figure 6: The FlightGear aircraft, augmentation on, reference loading: (a) single keyboard steps (5 % of travel) from the hover, stick centred; (b) a hands-off conversion from 40 kt, the nacelles commanded from 90 to 60°; (c) the trim feed-forward, the level-flight trim's stick against airspeed by nacelle angle; (d) an engine start on the ground, lever down.

5.7 Handling with the augmentation, and the start

These are not comparisons but checks of the FlightGear aircraft's augmentation (Fig. 6). In the hover one press of the

stick forward gives −1.0° of pitch, held, and one to the right 1.3° of roll after an overshoot; the heading holds with the pedals centred. With the nacelles commanded from 90 to 60° at 40 kt and nothing else touched, the aircraft accelerates to 158 kt with its pitch between −7.0 and 1.7°: the trim feedforward takes up the trim's change, the stick's trim moving from 65 % of its travel aft of centre in the hover at 75° to 76 % forward at 120 kt at 90°, which the bare aircraft would have the pilot hold. The nacelles stop at the corridor's lower boundary until the airspeed allows 60°, and later move on past it as the upper boundary comes down. Cold, with the lever down, the engines spool up one after the other and the rotors reach their governed speed 74 s after the first engine's start.

6 Corrections found during validation

The changes that the comparisons forced are listed here because each removed a physical or numerical inconsistency rather than tuning a coefficient.

1. *The sections' stall.* The sections first had C-81's NACA 0012 stall, the lift falling to a flat plate's within 6°. Its negative lift slope past the maximum took away the gimbal's aerodynamic damping, and at high thrust the gimbal diverged. The 64-series sections stall from the trailing edge and fall gently [12]; so do the model's now, the shape fitted to the hover test.
2. *The nacelles' mass.* Each nacelle's centre of gravity was placed on the wrong side of the conversion axis, which put the aircraft's 5 in forward.
3. *The governor.* Its error had the wrong sign: a rotor slower than its reference took more collective, so it slowed further. And its engagement was gated at an absolute rotor speed of 85–95 %, which turned it off in airplane mode at 84 %; it is gated relative to the reference now.
4. *The flaperons in slow airplane mode.* Retracted with the nacelles down, they left the wing unable to carry the aircraft at the corridor's lowest airplane-mode speeds; the schedule keeps 40° there.
5. *Test weights.* The tests' weight changes went into the cargo's point mass, which moved the centre of gravity with them; they are at the design centre of gravity now.
6. *The drive's torque limit* was applied as a power proportional to the rotor speed, so a start had almost no torque to turn the rotors up; it acts as a torque now, and the flight idle is the power the rotors need at flat pitch at their governed speed.
7. *The gear in the comparisons.* The harness first ran with the gear extended, JSBSim's default. Its drag stood in for drag the airframe lacks: the V-22's fitted drag (then 4.7 ft^2) met Boeing's polar and the airplane-mode speeds only with the gear down, and the XV-15's airplane-mode power looked close. All comparisons in forward flight are now gear up, the V-22's drag refitted, and the XV-15's shortfall reported (Section 5.2).
8. *The nacelle rate.* The nacelles' tilt rate, which moves the hubs and adds to the shafts' pitch rate in the flapping, was taken after the step had already set the new nacelle angle, so it was zero throughout. Taken from the step itself it changes no trim, and the pitch attitude through the conversion run (Section 5.7) by up to 1.6°.

Table 10: Summary: ✓ within the test's scatter, ~ partly, × not reproduced. Fitted: the comparison checks the shape only.

XV-15 rotor: hover power, C_T/σ = 0.08–0.18 (stall fitted)	✓
XV-15 rotor: hover power at low thrust; collective gradient	~
XV-15 download against flaps (fitted)	✓
XV-15 power through the conversion (altitudes bracketed)	✓
XV-15 power in helicopter mode, 45–94 kt	×
XV-15 power in airplane mode, gear up (Bell's drag)	×
V-22 airframe polar (drag fitted)	✓
V-22 maximum level speed, sea level and 17 000 ft	✓
V-22 hover ceiling (sea level fitted)	✓
V-22 download at 67°	~
V-22 pitch attitude through the conversion	✓
V-22 wing lift share through the conversion	~

7 Assessment

Table 10 summarises. The model reproduces what defines the tiltrotor's performance: the proprotor's hover power at operating thrust, the wing's download against its flaps, the airframe's polar, and the V-22's speeds and hover ceilings, the last three after one fitted drag area and one fitted torque limit, both against Boeing's own charts. Through the conversion the V-22's pitch attitude follows its flight test. Its open items are the helicopter mode's power against speed, where the XV-15's test shows a shallower bucket than the blade elements and the wake give; the drag Bell's coefficients lack, which the V-22 build supplies by a fit and the XV-15 build leaves; the wing's share of the lift at intermediate nacelle angles; and the V-22 wing's download. None of the V-22's dynamic responses could be compared: no frequency responses or time histories of the aircraft are public, and the XV-15's, which are [18], are left for further work. Its augmentation is a plausible control law, not the V-22's.

8 Conclusions

- A blade-element model of the gimballed tiltrotor, both rotors blade by blade with their gimbals, pitch–flap coupling and finite-state wakes, the wing in their ring-vortex wakes, the interconnected drive and the conversion corridor, runs in plain JSBSim, generated from data. It is the flight model of the FlightGear V-22.
- Built first as the XV-15 from Bell's simulation data and NASA's tests, its rotor gives the full-scale rotor's hover power at operating thrust, and its download follows the flight test's with the flap.
- Carried to the V-22 with its published data, one fitted drag area and one fitted torque limit, it gives Boeing's airframe polar, maximum speeds within 15 kt and hover ceilings within 5 %, and the flight test's pitch attitude through the conversion.
- Bell's airframe coefficients miss part of the flying aircraft's drag; with the gear up the XV-15 build needs a quarter to a third less power than its flight test in airplane mode.
- The helicopter mode's power against speed, the wing's lift through the middle of the conversion and the V-22's download are documented, not tuned away.

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